

Lesson 1: Simple Present Tense

Look at the daily routine of Bina, a class VIII student of Fatikchari Girls' High School. In pairs ask and answer questions about what Bina does at a particular time of a typical day.

Use the following as example:

A: What does Bina do at eight o'clock in the morning?

B: She starts for school at eight o'clock.

<u>Time</u>	<u>Activities</u>
6-00 am	get up from bed
7-00 am	have breakfast
7-30 am	prepare for school
8-00 am	go to school
1-00 pm	come back home
2-00 pm	have lunch
4-00 pm	go for a walk
6-30 pm	study at home

Now, in the same pair, talk about what you do at times shown in Bina's daily routine. Ask and answer questions about your daily activities. Use the example below:

A: What do you do at four o'clock in the afternoon?

B: I go to the field to play football.

Look at the pictures below. What profession do these people have? In pairs ask and answer questions about each picture. Use the example below:

A: What is his/her profession?

B: I think, he/she is a cook.

A: A cook? What does a cook do?

B: He/she cooks food in a restaurant.



What tense did you use for the activities you have done so far? Notice the verb forms you used when talking about Bina's routine and your daily activities. Also think about how you talked about the profession of the people in the pictures.

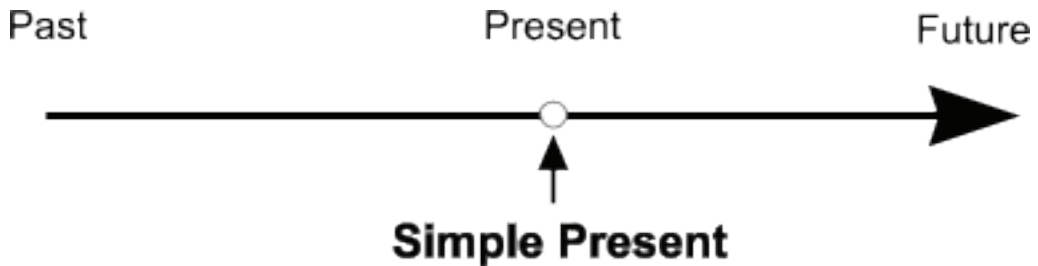
While doing those activities, you actually talked about facts in general.

Now read the section below to know more about simple present tense.

Simple Present is also called Present Simple. The Simple Present expresses an action in the present, taking place once, never or several times. It is also used for actions that take place one after another and for actions that are set by a timetable or schedule. The Simple Present also expresses facts in the present.

Look at the diagram below that shows the time we refer to while using Simple Present tense.

Can you explain the diagram? Share your ideas with a partner.



Now, read the section below to know about the uses of simple present tense:

1. Repeated Actions



Use the Simple Present to express the idea that an action is repeated or usual. The action can be a habit, a hobby, a daily event, a scheduled event or something that often happens. It can also be something a person often forgets or usually does not do.

Examples:

- The train **leaves** every morning at 8 am.
- The train **does not leave** at 9 am.
- When **does** the train usually **leave**?

2. Facts or Generalizations



In Simple Present a speaker can make statement about something that was true before, is true now, and will be true in the future.

Examples:

- Windows are made of glass.
- Windows are not made of wood.

3. Scheduled Events in the Near Future



Speakers occasionally use Simple Present to talk about scheduled events in the near future. This is most commonly done when talking about the timetable of transportation, but it can be used with other scheduled events too.

Examples:

- The train **leaves** tonight at 6 am.
- The bus **does not arrive** at 11 am, it **arrives** at 1 pm.
- When **do** we **board** the plane?
- The party **starts** at 8 o'clock.

Exercise 1

The following text describes the life of a fisherman. Rewrite the verbs in the bracket to make a paragraph in the simple present tense.

A fisherman (to be) an individual whose work is to catch fish in the ponds, canals and rivers and sell then in the local markets. His main profession (to be) to earn his living by catching and selling fish. He even (go) to the sea in groups to catch fish. He (have) to lead a miserable life as his daily income (to be) very meagre. Some fishermen (live) on the seashore and (catch) fish in the sea, while others (move) near the rivers during the rainy season. Again some (return) to village for repairing fishing nets and boats.

A fisherman (do) not know many things happening around him. He (keep) himself busy with fishing lines. His joy (know) no bounds when he (catch) a lot of fish.

Exercise 2

Read the passage and answer the questions below the passage:

Mr. Amin works at a bank. He is the manager. He starts work every day at 8:00. He finishes work every day at 6:00. He lives very close to the bank. He walks to work every day. His brother and sister also work at the bank. But, they do not live close to the bank. They drive cars to work. They start work at 9:00. In the bank, Mr. Amin is the boss. He helps all the workers and tells them what to do. He likes his job. He is also very good at his job. Many customers like Mr. Amin and they say hello to him when they come to the bank. He likes to talk to the customers and make them feel happy. Mr. Amin really likes his job.

Now, answer this questions:

1. What time does Mr. Amin start work?
2. Does Mr. Amin drive a car to work?
3. Does Mr. Amin talk to customers?
4. How does Mr. Amin feel about his job?

Lesson 2: Present Continuous Tense

Read the live radio commentary of a big sport event and notice the underlined parts.

Hello! listeners, welcome to the running commentary of the annual sport meet of Bangladesh Olympic Association. I am speaking from the National Stadium, Dhaka.

It's just eight o'clock in the morning and we are expecting the grand opening of the annual event

in next few minutes. As I am standing in front of the main gate, I can see the crowd enjoying this sunny morning in the Eastern gallery. Now, the President of Bangladesh Olympic Association is entering the ground along with the officials. The athletes are gathering in the field and they are warming up. Just now I can see a great athlete in front of me, two times gold medalist, Jamal Haider. He is waving his hands to the crowd and as you can hear, the spectators are happy to see their heroes and they are cheering so loud!



Discuss the question in pairs:

How is the commentator describing the actions that are taking place while he is talking i.e. what verb form is she/ he using here?

Now look at the people in the pictures below. In pairs ask and answer questions about what each of them are doing at this moment. Follow the examples below:

A: What is s/he doing?

B: S/he is ing.



watch TV



play violin



read books



playing computer games



play football



go to school



ride bicycle



skate



play badminton

What tense do we use to talk about some actions that is taking place at the time of talking? The tense we use for this is called **Present Continuous** tense. This tense is also known as **Present Progressive** tense.

Now, read the section below to know more about **Present Continuous (progressive)** tense.

The **Present Progressive** is a form of the verb that shows the action is going on in the present.



The Present Progressive is used for actions going on at the moment of speaking and for actions taking place only for a short period of time.

When do we use present continuous/progressive tense? Read the following sentences in present continuous tense. Can you find out the different uses of present continuous/progressive tense?

1. The boys are swimming in the pond.
2. He is studying medicine.
3. He is working very hard nowadays.
4. She is preparing a delicious curry tonight.
5. He is taking a basic computer course next month.
6. She is always making complains.

Now, read the section below to know more about when or where to use this tense.

We use Present Continuous/Progressive tense to talk about:

- Actions that are happening now (e.g. She is playing tennis.)
- Actions which are currently in progress may not be exactly at this moment/second e.g. She is studying astrology these days.)
- Planned future actions (e.g. We are starting a new course next month.)

Forming sentences in present continuous tense

You have so far looked at many examples of sentences in present continuous tense. Have you noticed how these sentences are formed? Discuss the following questions in pairs:

1. Can you form a sentence in the Present Continuous tense without an auxiliary verb?
2. What auxiliary verbs are used with different subjects to form these sentences?
3. What form does the main verb take in present continuous tense?

Now, read the following part to check your understanding of how sentences are formed in present continuous tense.

Who?	Form of verb (positive)	Form of verb (negative)
I	am + verb + ing	am + not + verb + ing
He/She/It	is + verb + ing	is + not + verb + ing
You	are + verb + ing	are + not + verb + ing
We	are + verb + ing	are + not + verb + ing
They	are + verb + ing	are + not + verb + ing

Now, look at this table to form questions in present continuous tense. Read the examples in the last column.

Auxiliary verbs	Who?	Form of verb	Examples
Am	I	verb + ing	Am I reading now?
Is	he/she	verb + ing	Is he reading now? Is she reading now?
Are	you	verb + ing	Are you reading now?
Are	we	verb + ing	Are we reading now?
Are	they	verb + ing	Are they reading now?

Exercise

Look at the picture. In pairs discuss the following questions about the persons in the picture.

1. Who are they?
2. Where are they sitting now?
3. What are they doing?



The text below describes the two persons in this picture. Write the verbs in the bracket in their correct forms and necessary auxiliary verbs.

Right now, it is Monday morning. Mamun and Tina are at home. They (sit) _____ at a table. They (eat) _____ breakfast. At this moment, Tina (drink) _____ coffee. She (eat) _____ cake. She (sit) _____ across the table from Mamun. He is Tina's husband. He (sit) _____ at the table with Tina. He also (drink) _____ coffee. Mamun (listen to) _____ Tina. After breakfast, Mamun and Tina (leave) _____ for work. They work in the city. They (ride) _____ the bus to work.

Lesson 3: Present Perfect Tense

Rajib and his friends have gathered in the school canteen to discuss their preparations for a cultural show. Read the conversation between Rajib and his friends and notice the underlined parts.

Rajib : Well, let's talk about the invitation card. When can we print them?

Mira : I have just talked to a press and the manager said he'd print them in two days.

Rajib : That's great! Now how about donations? Have we got enough money?

Momen: I have collected five hundred taka from bookshop.

Jalil : Our club chairman has already given two thousand.

Bonna : My sister has requested her boss to donate some money. He has agreed to help us.

Rajib : Okay, let's hope, he will give us a good amount of money. Has anyone talked with the decorators?

Momen: I have already talked to them. They will do the stage, lighting and the sound.

Rajib : Fantastic! Seems that all of you have done excellent jobs. Thank you.

As you read the underlined parts of the conversation, what have you noticed? What time do these expressions refer to?

Notice that, all the underlined parts refer to actions that were completed before the present time. Also notice that the friends are talking about actions that have finished recently. These underlined parts are examples of expressions in the **Present Perfect tense**.

When do we use Present Perfect tense? Read the following sentences in present perfect tense. Can you guess the different uses of Present Perfect tense?

1. He has answered the questions.
2. I have seen the film three times already.
3. He has just joined his new post.
4. I have never seen a crocodile before.
5. She has bought some food for us.
6. They have lived here for three years.

Now, read the section below to know more about when or where to use this tense.

Present Perfect tense is used for:

- Actions that happened at an unspecified time before the present (e.g. *They have invited all of us.*)
- Actions that have ended recently (e.g. *She has broken her leg.*)
- States that started in the past and are still continuing (e.g. *I have always liked him.*)

You have so far looked at many examples of sentences in present perfect tense.

Have you noticed how these sentences are formed? Discuss the following questions in pairs:

1. Can you form a sentence in the Present Perfect tense without an auxiliary verb?
2. What auxiliary verbs are used to form Present Perfect sentences?
3. What form does the main verb take in Present Perfect tense?

Now, read the following to check your understanding of how sentences are formed in the Present Perfect tense. They are formed by using past participle (pp) of the main verb after have/has.

Who?	Form of verb (positive)	Form of verb (negative)
I	have + verb (pp)	have + not + verb (pp)
He/She	has + verb (pp)	has+ not + verb (pp)
You	have + verb (pp)	have + not + verb (pp)
We	have + verb (pp)	have + not + verb (pp)

They have + verb (pp) have + not + verb (pp)

Now, look at this table to form questions in the Present Perfect tense. Read the example in the last column.

Auxiliary verbs	Who?	Form of verb	Examples
Have	I	verb (pp)	Have I received the money?
Has	he/she	verb (pp)	Has he received the money? Has she received the money? Has it been declared in time?
Have	you	verb (pp)	Have you received the money?
Have	we	verb (pp)	Have we received the money?
Have	they	verb (pp)	Have they received the money?

Exercise 1

Read the following story and rewrite the verbs in the brackets in correct forms with appropriate auxiliary verbs.

Recently, it (rain) in Munira's town. So far, she (see) rains three times. Munira always (love) the sound of the raindrops on her tin-shed house. She has (be) out in the rain two times before.

Munira's daughter, Mishu never (play) in the rain. This is her first experience of playing in the rain. Munira is worried about her daughter. She might catch a cold.

Munira just (buy) a new umbrella. She puts on her rain coat and goes out with the umbrella.



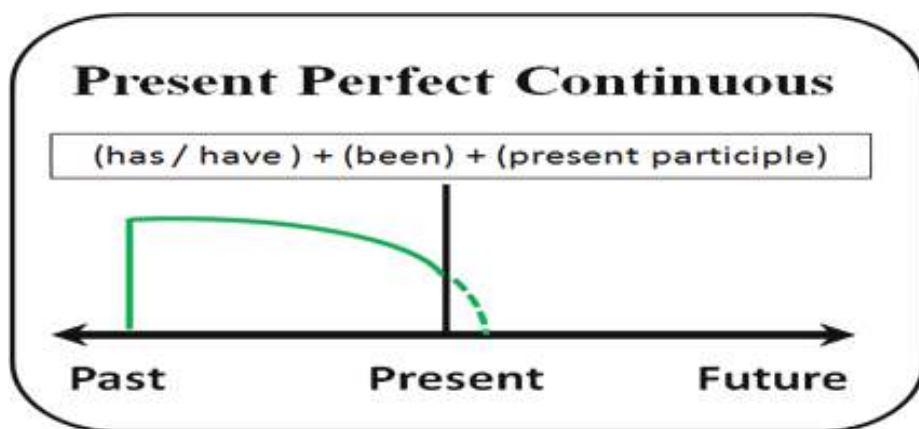
Exercise 2

Look at the list of some everyday activities in the box. In pairs ask and answer questions about what you have done today. Follow the example below:

A: Have you watched television today?

B: Yes, I have. I have watched a football match.

have shower
read the news paper
meet your teacher
have a heavy breakfast
do your homework



The Present Perfect continuous tense indicates that something began in the past and has continued up to now or has current relevance, or is likely to continue in future.

Lesson 4: Simple Past Tense

Read the story of Zahid, a student of class eight, who traveled to St. Martin's island last year. Read about his journey and discuss in pairs the following questions:

1. What problems did Zahid face during the journey?
2. How did he go to St. Martin's?
3. What things did he do at Cox's Bazar and St. Martin's island?

A Memorable Trip

I had a memorable trip to Cox's Bazar and St. Martin's Island when I was a student of class seven. I remember all the things happened to me during the trip. My uncle and aunt lived in Chittagong at that time and they invited us to visit them. My cousin Saleha was of the same age as I was. So I felt delighted when my mother told me about the visit. We live in Rajshahi and Chittagong is far away. First we planned to go to Dhaka by bus and then to Chittagong by train. One fine morning we got on a bus at Rajshahi at 7 o'clock in the morning. Normally, it takes about six hours to reach Dhaka from Rajshahi. Unfortunately, there was a huge traffic jam on the way and the journey took almost eight hours to reach Dhaka. So we had to stay in a hotel in Dhaka for the night and the next morning we took the train to Chittagong at 8 in the morning from Kamalapur railway station. We were unlucky again because the train also arrived late at Chittagong. But we felt happy because my uncle and aunt received us at the station.

Next morning we started for Cox's Bazar. We arrived there at about two and spent the rest of the day by the sea side. I had not seen the sea earlier so it was an exciting experience for me. We stayed at a hotel there. Early next morning we went to the beach again and saw the beautiful sunrise. We walked along the beach, bathed in sea water, ate sea food and enjoyed ourselves.

Read the text again and look at the words that express actions in the past. You will find that these actions words are all verbs. You will also find the be verbs (was and were) used in the sentences for describing a situation in the past.

The sentences that describe a past situation or action in the above text are in *Simple Past tense*.

Can you say when or where we use Simple Past tense? The Simple Past expresses an action in the past taking place once, never, several times.

Read the text below on Gautam Buddha and think about the uses of Simple Past tense.

Buddha was born in the year 563 B.C. at a place called Lumbini. His father Suddhodana was a Sakya king and his mother Maya also came from a princely family. Seven days after his birth his mother died, leaving him to the care of her sister and his step mother Mahajapati.

The young Buddha was brought up in Kapilavastha, the capital of Sakya kingdom. When he was born, several miracles occurred. His father and some prominent members of his court were aware that a divine child was born amidst them. His parents gave him the name Siddhartha. They expected him to grow and become a successful king.

Read the section below to know about the uses of Simple Past tense.

Simple Past tense is used to express -

- action in the past taking place once, never or several times
Example: He *visited* his parents every weekend.
- actions in the past taking place one after another
Example: He *came* in, *took* off his coat and *sat* down.
- action in the past taking place in the middle of another action
Example: When I was having breakfast, the phone suddenly *rang*.

Forming sentences in Simple Past tense

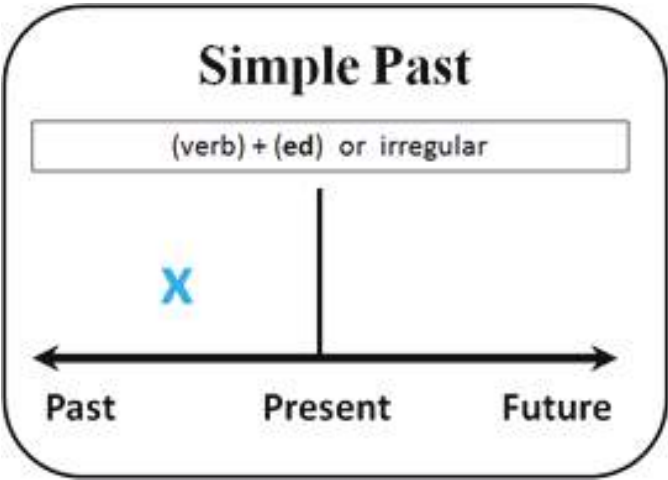
Discuss the questions in pairs:

1. How do you form sentences in simple past tense?
2. Do all simple past tense sentences have auxiliary verbs?
3. What form does the main verb take in simple past tense?
4. How do you form a question about the past?

Use the table to make sentences about past events.

I	Was	late tired nervous in a hotel a new comer hungry
We	Were	
He	Was	
She		
Raju		
They		
The students		

Study the rules below to understand how sentences are formed in simple past:



We use **was/were** as ‘**be**’ verbs to talk about the past. Now, look at the following table:

I	went	to Dubai
We	carried	some food with us
He	talked	to the counter clerk

She	hired	a taxi
They	cancelled	the trip

Exercise 1

In pairs talk about a journey you made. One partner will ask the following questions and the other will answer them in simple past tense.

1. Where did you go?
2. What transport did you take?
3. When did you start?
4. How long was the journey?
5. Did you take any luggage with you?
6. Did you face any troubles on the way?
7. When did you reach your destination?

Exercise 2

Put the verbs into the correct tense (Simple Past or Present Perfect). Note that we do not use the present perfect when past time is mentioned.

- A: I (see / not) ----- you for a long time. Where ----- (you / be)?
- B: I (come / just) ----- back from Cox's Bazar.
- A: Oh really? What (you / do) ----- there?
- B: I (stay) ----- at a hotel and (enjoy) ----- the beauty of the sea.

Lesson 5: Past Continuous Tense

Look at the pictures. In pairs discuss what time are the speakers referring to? Which tense has been used in these sentences?

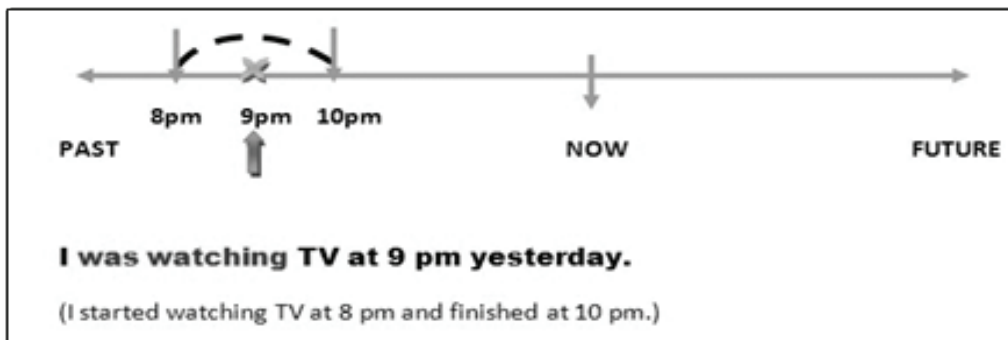


Practise this conversation in pairs.

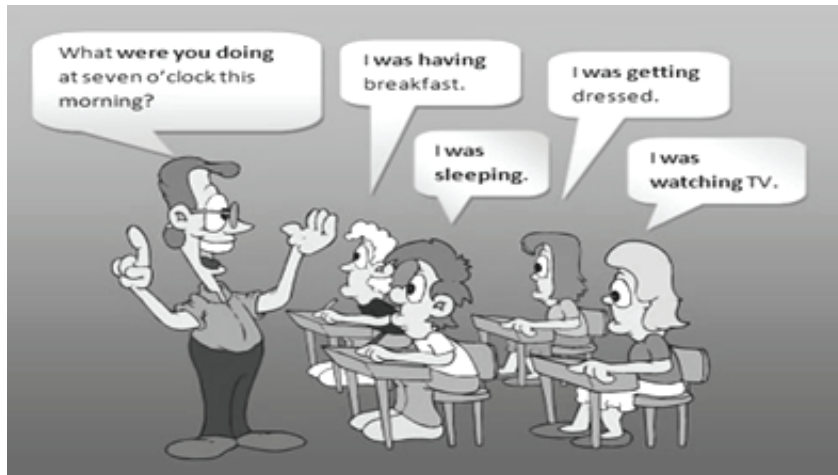
- A : What is wrong with your hand?
 B : I **broke** my hand yesterday.
 A : How did it happen?
 B : Well, I **fell** down.
 A : Oh, really! What **were** you **doing** at that time?
 B : I **was climbing** up a tree.
 A : So you **were climbing** a tree and you **fell** down and **broke** your hand.
 That's so sad!



Now look at the illustration below. Which tense does it talk about? Can you give some more examples of sentences like these?



Read what the students were doing at 7'o clock in the morning. What tense are they using in their reply? They are talking about what was happening in the past.



Read the text below. Underline the sentences in *Simple Past tense* and *Past Continuous tense*.

Yesterday, it was raining all day. Onu was playing inside the house. She wanted to be outside. She wasn't playing outside because it was raining. She was feeling tired of staying inside the house. Onu was trying to keep busy inside the house. She was reading her book until the electricity went out. Then, she decided to practise her sewing. She was practising sewing until lunchtime. After lunch, she sat by the window and watched the rain.



While Onu was watching the rain, the phone rang. Her mother was calling to say she was coming home. She played the games with her mother when she came home.

Discuss the questions in pairs:

- a) Why was Onu feeling tired?
- b) What were Onu doing to get herself busy?
- c) What did Onu do with her mother?
- d) How are the sentences formed in the past continuous?

Read about the uses of Past Simple and Past Continuous tense.

When we talk about two actions in the past taking place one after another, we use simple past tense for both the actions.

Example: *She came home and switched on the computer and checked her mails.*

But when we talk about two events in the past which were taking place at the same time, we use Past Continuous for describing both the actions.

Example: *Sumon was playing on the computer while his brother was watching.*

Non-progressive verbs

The following verbs are usually only used in Simple Past (not in the progressive form).

- **state:** be, cost, fit, mean, suit
Example: *We were on holiday.*
- **possession:** belong, have
Example: *Salam had a pet.*
- **senses:** feel, hear, see, smell, taste, touch
Example: *He felt the cold.*
- **feelings:** hate, hope, like, love, prefer, regret, want, wish
Example: *Joynal loved cakes.*
- **perceptions:** believe, know, think, understand
Example: *I did not understand him.*
- **introductory clauses for direct speech:** answer, ask, reply, say
Example: *"I am watching TV," he said.*

Exercise

Put the verbs into the correct tense (Simple Past or Past Progressive).

1. The receptionist (welcome) _____ the guests and (ask) _____ them to fill in the form.
2. The car (break) _____ down and we (have) _____ to walk home.
3. My father (come) _____ in, (look) _____ around and (tell) _____ me to tidy up my room.
4. While the parents (have) _____ breakfast, their children (run) _____ about.
5. Momota (turn) _____ off the lights and (go) _____ to bed.

Lesson 6: Simple Future Tense

Mr. Kabir is going to Singapore tomorrow. Here is his planning for the journey. Work in pairs, ask and answer the following questions.

The flight will leave Dhaka Sahjalal International Airport at 11.00 pm and I must report for checking-in at least two hours before the departure time. I shall start for the airport by 7.00 pm so that I can reach the airport in time. There will be heavy traffic on the Airport Road at this time. If I start by 7.00 pm, I'll have enough time in hand to reach the airport. I am going to



take only a small suitcase and a laptop with me. So, there won't be any hassle with my baggage. I have not got any foreign currency but I am going to buy some dollars from the airport. This will be a short flight and I hope to arrive at the Chengi Airport, Singapore in 3 hours.

Questions

- a) What time will the flight leave Shahjalal International Airport?
- b) What things is Mr. Kabir taking with him?
- c) What tense is used by Mr. Kabir to talk about the travel?

In the passage above Mr. Kabir talks about the events/actions that will happen in future. So he uses Simple Future tense to talk about the things that will take place in future.

Read the following sentences. Can you see a common structure in them? In pairs, try to identify the structure.

- The flight will leave Dhaka Sahjalal International Airport at 1.00 pm.
- I shall start for the airport by 7-00 pm.
- There will be heavy traffic on the Airport Road.
- This will be a short flight.
- There won't be any hassle with my baggage.

Now, read the following section to check your understanding of Simple Future tense.

To make sentences in the Simple Future tense, we put **'will'** or **'...ll'** before the base form of the verb.

For the negative we put **'will not'** or **'won't'** in front of the verb. With subjects like 'I' or 'we', we can also say 'shall'/shan't.

To make questions in the future, we put 'will' or 'shall' in front of the subject.

With 'I' and 'We' you can use **shall**. This usually means a suggestion or that something is not certain.

Examples:

Shall we go to the cinema?



What shall I wear for the party?

What will you be in future? Tell your friends in your class. (hints: teacher, doctor, pilot, nurse, etc.)

Read the sentences below and notice how we talk about future plans.

I am going to buy some dollars from the airport.

I am going to take only a small suitcase and a laptop with me

She is going to sit for the exam next year.

Now, read the text below and notice the future expressions with *going to + verb*.

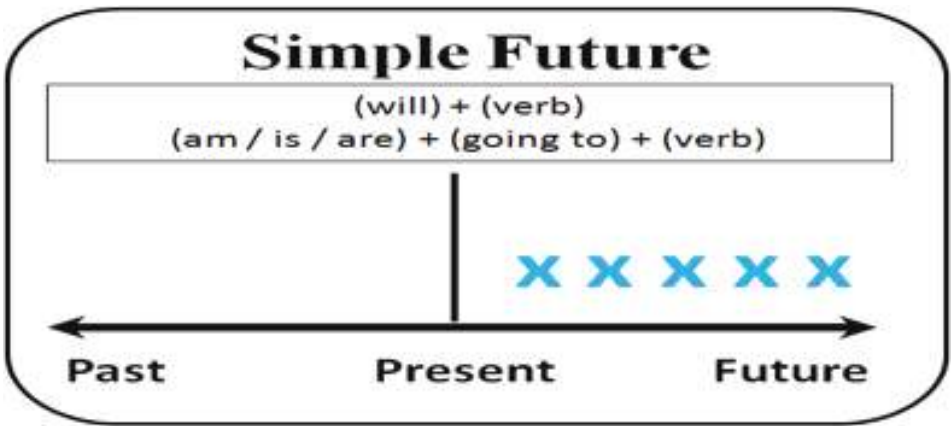
On Saturday, Noboni will be three years old. Her parents are going to have a birthday party. The party is going to begin at noon on Saturday. Many people will be invited at the party. Noboni will have so much fun!

Noboni's mother is going to cook *polaow* and chicken curry. Her father is going to buy a special cake. It will be a chocolate cake. Noboni will love her cake! Her grandmother is going to bring some ice cream and her aunt is going to buy her a nice dress.

All of Noboni’s relatives will bring beautiful presents. Noboni is going to have a nice birthday this year!



So, we can see that there are two ways to talk about simple future.



Now look at the structures for talking about future actions with *going to + verb*.

I	am		attend	a party tonight.
You	are		see	the teacher this evening
We	are	going to	plan	a surprise party for Ali today.
S/he	is		meet	her parents soon.
They	are		play	a friendly match.

Exercise 1

Kona met a fortune teller once. Though she does not believe in fortune telling, she wanted to have some fun and so, asked the fortune teller to tell about her future. The fortune teller was also very funny. Here is what the fortune teller told her. Complete the sentences with appropriate auxiliary verbs.

1. You (earn) _____ a lot of money.
2. You (travel) _____ around the world.
3. You (meet) _____ lots of interesting people.
4. Everybody (admire) _____ you.
5. You (not / have) _____ any problems.
6. Many people (serve) _____ you.
7. They (anticipate) _____ your wishes.
8. There (not / be) _____ anything left to wish for.
9. Everything (be) _____ perfect.
10. But all these things (happen / only) _____ if you marry me.

Exercise 2

Ms. Selina Rahman is talking about her holiday. Complete the sentences. Put the verbs in brackets into the Simple Future tense.

1. I..... my holidays with my parents this year. (spend)
2. We at my parents' house in Khulna. (stay)
3. My father at the station to receive me. (be)
4. I..... some warm clothes. (need)
5. I..... some presents for my parents. (take)
6. It..... a great time with my parents. (be)

Exercise 3

Talk about your future plans in pairs. Say at least three things that you are going to do next week. Use the 'going to' form.